LUKAS HENSEL

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PRIMARY RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics; Labor Economics; Political Economy; Health Economics

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

Current

Associate Professor, Guanghua School of Management, Peking University — Since Feb. 2026

Past

Assistant Professor, Guanghua School of Management, Peking University — Feb. 2023–Feb. 2026

Visiting Researcher, CSAE, University of Oxford — Jun. 2021–Aug. 2024

Postdoctoral Researcher, Guanghua School of Management, Peking University — Jun. 2021–Jan. 2023

Postdoctoral Researcher, Blavatnik School of Government, University of Oxford — Sep. 2019–Feb. 2021

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Economics, University of Oxford — 2020

Master of Philosophy in Economics, University of Oxford — 2016

B.Sc. International Economics, University of Tübingen — 2014

RESEARCH

Publications

1. Hensel, L., Tekleselassie, T., & Witte, M. (2026). Formalized Employee Search and Labor Demand. *Journal of Development Economics*, 103876.

2. Hager, A., Hensel, L., Roth, C., & Stegmann, A. (2025). Voice and Political Engagement: Evidence from a Field Experiment. *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, 107(4), 1149–1158.

3. Hager, A., Hensel, L., Hermle, J., & Roth, C. (2025). Political Activists are Not Driven by Instrumental Motives: Evidence from Two Natural Field Experiments. *British Journal of Political Science*, 55, e88.

4. Hager, A., Hensel, L., Hermle, J., & Roth, C. (2023). Political Activists as Free-Riders: Evidence from a Natural Field Experiment. *The Economic Journal*, 133(653), 2068–2084.

5. Hager, A., Hensel, L., Hermle, J., & Roth, C. (2022). Group Size and Protest Mobilization across Movements and Countermovements. *American Political Science Review*, 116(3), 1051–1066.

6. Hensel, L., Witte, M., Caria, S., Fetzer, T., Fiorin, S., Goetz, F. M., ... Jachimowicz, J. M. (2022). Global Behaviors, Perceptions, and the Emergence of Social Norms at the Onset of the COVID-19 Pandemic. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 193, 473–496.

7. Fetzer, T., Hensel, L., Hermle, J., & Roth, C. (2021). Coronavirus Perceptions and Economic Anxiety. *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, 103(5), 968–978.

8. Hager, A., Hermle, J., Hensel, L., & Roth, C. (2021). Does Party Competition Affect Political Activism? *The Journal of Politics*, 83(4), 1681–1694.

9. Christian, C., Hensel, L., & Roth, C. (2019). Income Shocks and Suicides: Causal Evidence From Indonesia. *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, 101(5), 905–920.

Under Revision

Designing Severance Insurance: Theory and Evidence from Ethiopia (joint with Girum Abebe, Stefano Caria, François Gerard, and Sara Spaziani), Accepted Stage 1 Registered Report, Journal of Development Economics.

Jobseekers' Beliefs about Comparative Advantage and (Mis)Directed Search (joint with Rob Garlick, Andrea Kiss, and Kate Orkin), Revised and Resubmitted, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics.

From Followers to Leaders: The Career Impact of High-Quality Managers (joint with Yuyu Chen and Xinjue Yao), Revise and Resubmit, Management Science.

Working Papers

Facts, Role Models, and Frontline Effort: Evidence from Garment Workers in Vietnam (joint with Yuyu Chen and Xinjue Yao).

Mitigating the Consequences of Job Loss in Lower-Income Countries: Evidence from Ethiopia (joint with Girum Abebe, Stefano Caria, and François Gerard), IZA Discussion Paper 18537.

Feedback, Confidence and Job Search Behavior (joint with Tsegay Tekleselassie, Marc Witte, Jonas Radbruch, and Ingo E. Isphording), IZA Discussion Paper 17761, superseded by the March 2026 draft.

Wage Information and Applicant Selection (joint with Maria Balgova, Tsegay Tekleselassie, and Marc Witte), IZA Discussion Paper 18220.

Mutual Knowledge of Social Norms and Political Behavior (joint with Anselm Hager, Elnura Kazakbaeva, and Damir Esenaliev), IZA Discussion Paper 17748.

Select Work in Progress

Employer Screening Technology and Hiring (joint with Robert Garlick, Kate Orkin, and Jennifer Kades), South Africa; analysis underway.

Do Labor Market Frictions Reduce Employment in Low-Income Countries? Experimental Evidence from Ethiopia (joint with Stefano Caria, Pieter Gautier, Francesco Losma, and Marc Witte), Ethiopia; fieldwork underway.

When, Not How Much: Work-Time Preferences and the Value of Schedule Changes (joint with Haoran He, Qian Weng, and Songyu Yu), China; analysis underway.

AI Adoption and Gender: Experimental Evidence on the Role of Competition (joint with Yiting Chen, Xiting Cui, and Juanjuan Meng).

Women's Group Empowerment Can Increase Political Participation: Evidence from Five Coordinated Field Experiments (joint with Damir Esenaliev, Anselm Hager, and Elnura Kazakbaeva), Kyrgyzstan; EGAP Metaketa V.

CONFERENCES AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: Beijing BEAT; CSAE Conference; GRIPS; JADE Conference
2025: Seoul National University; Korean Development Institute; CSAE Conference; Wuhan University; ESA World Congress; SUSTech, Shenzhen; German Development Economics Conference
2024: Frankfurt School of Finance and Management; Beijing Normal University; CSAE Conference; Dutch Development Economics (DuDE) Workshop; Beijing BEAT; 2024 Jobs and Development Conference; PKU School of Economics; PKU National School of Development; University of Tokyo
2023: Guanghua School of Management; Workshop on Subjective Expectations, Bocconi University; Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society; PKU HSBC Business School Shenzhen; Renmin University; University of Essex; University of Göottingen; Royal Holloway University London
2022: German Development Economics Conference; CSAE Conference 2022
2021: Field Days; NEUDC; European Economic Association Conference; CSAE Workshop, University of Oxford; Hertie School of Government; Postdoc Seminar, University of Oxford; Applied Development Economics Conference; Guanghua School of Management (2x)
2020: CSAE Workshop, University of Oxford
2019: Graduate Seminar, University of Exeter x 2; briq Summer School in Behavioral Economics; IZA Summer School in Labour Economics; Spring School in Behavioral Economics, San Diego; CSAE Conference - University of Oxford
2018: Graduate Seminar, University of Exeter; CSAE Workshop, University of Oxford; Applied Micro Seminar, University of Cologne; NEUDC, Cornell University; European Economic Association Conference; 2nd Evidence-Based Economics Summer Meeting; Applied Coffee - Institute on Behavior and Inequality (briq); Applied Microeconomics Seminar - University of Oxford
2017: NEUDC, Tufts University; Postdoc and DPhil Workshop - University of Oxford; RES Junior Scholar Symposium; CSAE Conference 2017

REVIEWING

Journal of Political Economy; Management Science; Review of Economics and Statistics; Journal of the European Economic Association; American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; American Economic Journal: Microeconomics; Economic Journal; American Political Science Review; Journal of Public Economics; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Labour Economics; World Development; Lancet Global Health; Economic Development and Cultural Change; World Bank Economic Review; Journal of African Economies; Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics; Economica; European Economic Review; Journal of Development Studies; British Journal of Political Science; Journal of Politics

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

"Advanced Econometrics II: Experimental Methods" **2024, 2025, 2026**
Advanced PhD course, Guanghua School of Management

"Topics in Behavioral Economics" **2023, 2025**
Advanced PhD course, Guanghua School of Management

"Research Seminar" **2025**
Undergraduate thesis writing course, Guanghua School of Management

"Development Economics" **2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025**
Advanced undergraduate course, Guanghua School of Management

"The Practice of RCTs" **2020**
MSc in Economics for Development, University of Oxford

GRANTS, PRIZES, AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Selected grants

National Scale Online Labour Market Interventions for Disadvantaged, Majority-Female Job- seekers in South Africa with Robert Garlick, Kate Orkin, Alice Cahill, Jennifer Kades EUR 1,498,840
(Fund for Innovation in Development; 2025–2028)

Expectations, Mental Health, and Behavior Along the Employment Relationship RMB 800,000
(National Science Foundation of China; 2026–2028)

Mitigating the Consequences of Job Loss in Ethiopia USD 275,000
with Girum Abebe, Stefano Caria, and Francois Gerard (IGC, Stone Center, JPAL JOI and SPI; 2022–now)

Can Shortlisting on Soft Skills Yield Better Firm-Worker Matches? USD 365,000
with Robert Garlick and Kate Orkin (JPAL JOI and NSF; 2020–now)

Boosting Worker Productivity in a New Industrial Park in Ethiopia USD 250,000
with Girum Abebe, Stefano Caria, and Stefan Dercon (IZA || G^2LM; 2020–2024)

EGAP Metaketa V: Women's Action Committees and Local Services USD 230,000
with Anselm Hager, Damir Esenaliev, and Elnura Kazakbaeva (Metaketa V; 2020–2024)

Job Adverts, Information, and Applicant Selection USD 60,000
with Marc Witte, and Tsegay Tekleselassie (IGC; 2019–2022)

Formal Hiring Practices, Firm Growth, and Inclusive Labor Markets £75,000
with Marc Witte and Tsegay Tekleselassie (PEDL/IGC/CSAE; 2018–2020)

Prizes

Young Economist Award **August 2018**
European Economic Association (EEA) Conference 2018

Scholarships

Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC) **October 2016 - December 2018**
German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) **October 2014 - June 2016**
German National Academic Foundation **March 2011 - June 2016**